

# File Naming Convention Guide

## Document Information

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## 1. Introduction

A consistent file naming convention is essential for an organized digital filing system. Well-named files are easier to locate, sort, identify, and manage. This guide establishes the naming standards used throughout the Professional Digital Filing System.

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## 2. Purpose

The purpose of this guide is to:

- Standardize file names.
- Improve document retrieval.
- Reduce duplicate files.
- Support version control.
- Promote professional document management.
- Ensure consistency throughout the filing system.

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## 3. Why File Naming Matters

Using a standard naming convention helps to:

- Find files quickly.
- Keep files organized.
- Improve collaboration.
- Simplify backups.
- Reduce confusion.
- Prevent accidental overwriting.
- Maintain a professional portfolio.

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## 4. Naming Standards

Every filename should:

- Clearly describe the document.
  - Be concise and meaningful.
  - Be consistent.
  - Use proper capitalization.
  - Include dates where appropriate.
  - Include version numbers when necessary.
  - Avoid unnecessary abbreviations.
-

## 5. General File Naming Format

Use the following structure whenever applicable:

`YYYY-MM-DD_DocumentName_Version.Extension`

Example:

`2026-07-05_ProjectMeetingMinutes_V1.docx`

For documents that do not require dates or version numbers, use:

`DocumentName.Extension`

Example:

`Digital Filing System Project Report.pdf`

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## 6. Naming Rules

### Rule 1: Use Descriptive Names

Good examples:

`Monthly Sales Report.pdf`  
`CSC101_Assignment01.docx`

Poor examples:

`Document1.docx`  
`New File.pdf`

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### Rule 2: Use Dates Consistently

Always use the international date format:

`YYYY-MM-DD`

Example:

`2026-07-05_ProjectProposal.docx`

This format sorts files correctly in chronological order.

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## Rule 3: Use Version Numbers

For documents that go through revisions, include version numbers.

Examples:

```
Project_Proposal_V1.docx
Project_Proposal_V2.docx
Project_Proposal_Final.pdf
```

Avoid filenames such as:

```
Final_Final.docx
Final2.docx
```

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## Rule 4: Use Meaningful Keywords

Include words that describe the content.

Examples:

- Invoice
  - MeetingMinutes
  - Assignment
  - Proposal
  - Budget
  - Report
  - Certificate
- 

## Rule 5: Use Spaces or Underscores Consistently

Choose one style and use it consistently.

Examples:

```
Monthly Sales Report.pdf
```

or

```
Monthly_Sales_Report.pdf
```

Do not mix styles within the same project.

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## 7. File Naming Examples

### Administration

2026-07-05\_MeetingMinutes\_ITDepartment.docx  
Office Policy Manual.pdf

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### Finance

Invoice\_2026\_001.xlsx  
Budget\_2026.xlsx  
Expense Report\_June2026.pdf

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### School

CSC101\_Assignment01.docx  
Database Systems Notes.pdf  
Semester 2 Timetable.pdf

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### Books

Volume01\_Chapter01\_Introduction.docx  
Volume02\_Chapter01\_CRM.docx  
Book Outline.pdf

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### Projects

Digital Filing System Project Plan.pdf  
Digital Filing System Project Report.pdf  
Project Presentation.pptx

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### Personal

Curriculum Vitae.pdf  
National ID.pdf  
Career Development Plan.docx

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## Portfolio

Professional Digital Filing System.pdf

GitHub Repository Guide.pdf

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## 8. Folder-Specific Naming Conventions

| Folder         | Example Filename                                         |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Administration | Meeting Minutes_2026-07-05.docx                          |
| Finance        | Invoice_2026_001.xlsx                                    |
| Projects       | Digital Filing System Project Plan.pdf                   |
| School         | CSC101_Assignment02.docx                                 |
| Books          | Volume03_Chapter02_DataAnalytics.docx                    |
| Reports        | Monthly Performance Report.pdf                           |
| Portfolio      | Business Intelligence Dashboard.pdf                      |
| Backups        | Professional Digital Filing System Backup_2026-07-05.zip |

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## 9. Version Control

When multiple revisions exist:

| Version | Description      |
|---------|------------------|
| V1      | First draft      |
| V2      | Revised draft    |
| V3      | Final review     |
| Final   | Approved version |

Example:

Digital Filing System Project Report\_V1.docx

Digital Filing System Project Report\_V2.docx

Digital Filing System Project Report\_Final.pdf

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## 10. Date Format

Always use:

YYYY-MM-DD

Examples:

2026-07-05

2026-08-15

Do not use:

05-07-2026

July 5, 2026

5-7-26

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## 11. Characters to Avoid

Do not use:

\ / : \* ? " < > |

Also avoid:

- Multiple spaces
  - Excessively long filenames
  - Unclear abbreviations
  - Emoji in filenames
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## 12. Best Practices

- Keep filenames short but descriptive.
  - Be consistent throughout the filing system.
  - Include dates when appropriate.
  - Use version numbers for revised documents.
  - Save final reports as PDF.
  - Keep editable copies in DOCX format.
  - Review filenames before saving.
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## 13. Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Using generic filenames.
  - Creating multiple "Final" files.
  - Mixing naming styles.
  - Using prohibited characters.
  - Omitting important keywords.
  - Saving different versions without version numbers.
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## 14. Related Documents

- User Guide
  - Digital Filing System Folder Structure Guide
  - Folder Creation Procedure
  - File Organization Procedure
  - Document Filing Procedure
  - Procedure for Saving Files
  - File Retrieval Procedure
  - File Backup and Recovery Procedure
  - Archive Management Procedure
  - Duplicate File Management Procedure
  - File Permission Management Procedure
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## 15. Conclusion

A standardized file naming convention is fundamental to an effective digital filing system. Consistent and descriptive filenames make documents easier to identify, retrieve, sort, and maintain. By following the standards outlined in this guide, users can improve productivity, reduce duplication, and ensure that the Professional Digital Filing System remains organized, scalable, and professional.